



Kristi Hettrick

Mother of the Year

If there is one person who deserves to be admired, it would be the mother of one Jackson Main: Kristi Hettrick. Not only did she work hard to take care of two amazing children, but she also has a long and amazing career in fundraising for a myriad of organizations. After losing her job at a candle making company in the 2008 financial crisis, she went on to work for Community of Christ and make their popular “Jack and Jen” Videos before moving to do fundraising work for the harvesters food bank for many years. And spent several years working to help people all across the Kansas City metropolitan area get a series of warm meals for them each and every day, and helped raise hundreds of thousands of dollars for the food bank. She then took up a new position as the Director of Development for the

University of until 2020, focused on individual major gift fundraising in support of cardiovascular medicine and the Center for Advanced Heart Care. And now, she works to help the future of our country by helping raise money from Graceland alumni and several other groups and organizations to help the university with any problem they may have as Vice President for Institutional Advancement for Graceland University. Helping improve the lives of Graceland students, faculty, and staff so they may all excel at their work. But it isn’t just her impressive fundraising work that makes one admire her. It’s her kindness and determination that makes her such an amazing human being. No matter what happens, she always strives to help people. It doesn’t matter if she’s your child, a distant relative, or

someone she just met off the street. If you are kind to Kristi Hettrick, she will be kind to you in return. But she isn't just a door mat either. Kristi Hettrick doesn't take rude and ignorant people lying down. And has no tolerance for foolish people who think they're better than everyone else, or are just flat out intolerant towards other people. As such, she always strives to rise above these people and prove them wrong by being kind to others. And in case it wasn't clear from earlier, she is one incredible mother. Not only did she help raise two amazing children, Casey Main and Jack Main, who have grown to become incredibly kind and caring people, she also practically raised a lot of other children as well. She helped care for and raise the two children of her new spouse, Alan Waterman, and each of them have grown to become incredibly gifted and talented people. She is also incredibly kind to the friends of her children, and acts almost like "A second mom" to them, according to Jack Main's friend, Nico.

And she also is a friend and mento to practically all of her large extended family. I believe what first made Jack Main admire his mother was his first memory of her when he was very young. He walked into the kitchen of their suburban home and asked for some apple juice. And immediately, Kristi Hettrick dropped everything to help her son. Jack Main didn't think much of it at the time, but he now realizes that this memory truly encapsulates the kind of person that Kristi Hettrick is. She always tries her best to help those she cares about. Whether its getting them a glass of apple juice from the fridge of their suburban home in Missouri, or helping that same person find a job later in life to help pay to fix their car, Kristi Hettrick always strives to do what is best for herself, her children, her family, and the people she cares so deeply about. And trust me, it's a lot of people.

